



Propagator

The Monthly Newsletter of the South Orange County Amateur Radio Association

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General Meeting

NPM Center
May 18, 2026
6:30 PM
Norman P. Murray
Center
23492 Veterans
Way, Mission Viejo,
CA 92692

President's Message

I want to thank all SOARA members who participate in our activities as well as those who are paid members but do not regularly attend meetings or events. Your dues support the continued operation of SOARA's repeaters and other activities. If you have not yet paid your dues for 2025/2026, please consider doing so as soon as possible. I'll be sending out an individualized reminder to all of those who still owe 2025/2026 dues.

SOARA's next big event is ARRL Field Day, with setup starting Friday, June 26 at around 3 p.m. Operating will commence at 11:00 a.m. PDT on Saturday, June 27. The 24 hour operating period will end on Sunday, June 28 at 11:00 a.m. PDT. We will then tear down and pack away our equipment for next year. The full rules are available at <https://www.arrl.org/files/file/Field-Day/2026/2026-Field-Day-Rules.pdf>

As in prior years, we will likely operate Class 3A, with a power limit of 100W. We will have a VHF station and a GOTA station. As in past years, if you operate Field Day from home or mobile, you can list SOARA in your own Field Day results documents and SOARA will also receive credit for your contacts, as will you.

There are many details to discuss regarding our Field Day setup at our Monday, May 18 meeting. Some of the things we must decide include: a) antennas for 40M/80M; b) what radios will be made available by members for use during the event; c) logging computers/monitors; d) food and beverages (on site cook or meals from local restaurants; e) GOTA station; and f) antenna locations. We really need the input of all interested members, both those who have attended prior SOARA Field Days and from members who have never operated at a Field Day exercise.

As in recent years, we want to be sure that all members that want to operate a station during the event will have ample opportunity to do so. I would hope that everyone who is on site will take time to get on the air for at least 15 minutes.

Let's all help make Field Day in 2026 the best one yet. Remember, this event is held to help us all train on emergency operating procedures and what we might have to do to help our community if a large scale disaster hit our area. Of course, we should enjoy ourselves at the same time.

73,

Dale Tyler - W6EDT

Membership Meeting

May Membership Meeting – Field Day Planning Night

Our May membership meeting will take a different format this month as we begin planning for our upcoming ARRL Field Day in June.

Instead of a guest speaker presentation, this meeting will focus on ideas, coordination, and planning for Field Day operations at Gilleran Park in Mission Viejo. We encourage all members to attend and participate — whether you are a longtime Field Day operator or have never attended before.

Field Day is one of the biggest and most enjoyable events of the year for our club. It takes teamwork and volunteer support to make it successful, and this meeting is a great opportunity to help shape this year's event.

Topics will include:

- Station setup and operating plans
- Antennas and equipment
- Power and networking needs
- Food and hospitality ideas
- Setup/teardown logistics
- Public outreach and demonstrations
- Volunteer opportunities
- New ideas to improve this year's event

Please join us for this important planning meeting and help make this year's Field Day our best one yet!

SOARA Saturday Report

We were at Gilleran Park. Greg brought donuts. We took in enough to pay Greg \$20 for the donuts and a \$0 balance for May. If you eat a donut, please pitch in something. There were several generous donations. Thank you everyone. Also one member brought a second dozen! Thank you.

Thanks John for the additional photos!

Mark setup a CW station, Dale brought free stuff donated to SOARA, I brought some meshcore radios to demo, I forgot the clipboard so no attendee list this month.





The next SOARA Saturday will be May 16 at Gilleran Park. 9 am to noon. Donuts will be provided. Bring a radio demo, operate UHF/VHF, HF, Satellite, or something else.

73,
Ed WA6ED

Recommend Links

A few links to check out from the last month.

Jeff, K06JCA, shared Ham Radio Myth busters:

<https://m.youtube.com/@BustRadioMyths/videos>

Here's a local SoCal ham, Adam. Great small antennas and portable ops:

<https://www.youtube.com/@K6ARK>

Ray, K6NOV

General Advice – Ham Radio Domestic & International Travel

Always travel with:

A copy of your FCC license (paper and digital).

Receipts or proof of ownership for your radio equipment—especially for international trips to prove you didn't buy the gear abroad (to avoid import duties).

A summary or description of the equipment and its use, in case customs or TSA officers aren't familiar with ham radio.

Label Your Gear Clearly: Label items like transceivers, tuners, and power supplies with your callsign and contact info. It adds legitimacy and helps in case of lost or questioned equipment.

Know What You're Bringing:

Be mindful of battery sizes (especially lithium-ion) and whether they're allowed in carry-on vs. checked bags.

No antennas that resemble weapons (e.g., long whip antennas, metal rods) in carry-on—these can be flagged.

TSA and Domestic U.S. Travel Tips

TSA Notification Card: You don't have to register with TSA, but bringing a printed TSA notification card (you can find one on [TSA.gov](https://www.tsa.gov)) that explains your gear is helpful.

Check or Carry-On?: Carry-on is often better for sensitive gear, but large setups (like HF rigs) might go checked. Pack smart, pad everything well.

Be Polite and Patient: If TSA inspects your equipment, explain briefly and confidently that you are a licensed FCC amateur radio operator and this is personal communications gear.

International Travel Advice

Check CEPT & IARP Agreements:

Europe follows CEPT Recommendation T/R 61-01, which recognizes your Extra class license in many countries for short-term use.

Countries like Germany, France, Spain, Italy, etc., participate—just carry a CEPT-format license (the FCC doesn't issue them officially, but your regular license suffices with a note or translation stating CEPT compatibility).

Consider printing out the CEPT agreement and translation in the local language of your destination country.

Temporary Operating Permissions:

Some countries require you to notify them in advance, even with CEPT—always check local national telecom regulations.

If the country isn't under CEPT or IARP (like Japan or China), you may need to apply for a special temporary permit in advance.

Customs Declarations:

Use CBP Form 4457 in the U.S. before departure to register your gear and avoid paying duty when returning.

Some EU countries might ask for a "Carnet" or declaration of temporary import, but it's rare for personal gear.

Operating Abroad

Callsign Prefixes: You'll typically need to prefix your callsign with the country code (e.g., DL/W1ABC in Germany).

Band Plans and Power Limits: These may vary—especially for 2m/70cm. Always check country-specific band allocations.

Other Warnings & Tips

- Respect Local Rules: Avoid transmitting until you've confirmed it's legal in the country.
- Language Barriers: Consider printing a basic description of amateur radio in the local language to explain to authorities or curious bystanders.
- Avoid Airport Operating: Don't try to operate from the airport unless you want an exciting visit from security.
- Portable Antennas: Wire antennas are less suspicious than metal elements. Magnetic loops or wire dipoles tend to travel

Tom, KI6DDB

SOARA - Statement of Cash Income & Expenses **October 1, 2025 Through April 30, 2026**

SOARA - Statement of Cash Income & Expenses			
October 2025 Through April 2026			
Seven Months:	April	April	Increase
	<u>2026</u>	<u>2025</u>	<u>(Decrease)</u>
Cash Income:			
Memberships	7,785	9,393	(1,608)
Other & Interest	<u>2,076</u>	<u>1,844</u>	<u>232</u>
Total Cash Income	<u>9,861</u>	<u>11,237</u>	<u>(1,376)</u>
Cash Expenses:			
Repeaters including site			
rental, utilities & insurance	4,504	4,166	338
Member Activities	2,833	2,174	659
Other expenses	<u>2,692</u>	<u>1,078</u>	<u>1,614</u>
Total Cash Expenses	<u>10,029</u>	<u>7,418</u>	<u>2,611</u>
Cash Net Income	(167)	3,819	(3,986)
Beginning Cash-October 1	<u>28,179</u>	<u>25,745</u>	<u>2,434</u>
Ending Cash- April 30	28,012	29,564	(1,552)
Note: If any member has questions about the financials, please			
contact the Treasurer or any Board member.			

Ron Mosher - K0PGE, SOARA Treasurer

Calendars

Upcoming SOARA Events

Dates are subject to change. Check the SOARA Web Site (<http://www.soara.org>) to verify locations and times

This Month...

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|--------------------|--|
| May 16 9 AM – Noon | - SOARA Elmer Saturday, Gilleran Park |
| May 18 6:00 PM | - HAM Radio License Exams, Murray Center |
| May 18 6:30 PM | - General Meeting, Murray Center |
| May 25 7:00 PM | - Board Meeting, Murray Center |

Next Month...

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|---------------------|--|
| June 15 6:00 PM | - HAM Radio License Exams, Murray Center |
| June 15 6:30 PM | - General Meeting, Murray Center |
| June 20 9 AM – Noon | - SOARA Elmer Saturday, Gilleran Park |
| June 26 3:00 PM | - Field Day Setup, Gilleran Park |
| June 27-28 All Day | - ARRL Field Day, Gilleran Park |

SOARA Information

SOARA meets at the Norman P. Murray Center, 24932 Veterans Way, Mission Viejo, CA on the third Monday of every month at 7:00 PM. For the months of January and February the third Monday is a holiday and the meeting is held on the fourth Monday.

License Exams: Amateur License Exams are given prior to SOARA meetings, except June. Exams are at 6pm. Prior registration is not required and walk-in applicants are welcome. For June, exams are held at Field Day. For further information, email Steve Kuver, K6UVR, at k6uvr@soara.org.

SOARA Library: SOARA has many amateur radio related books such as hand books, books about electrical theory, etc. available to lend out to club members. Contact library@soara.org for more info.

Web Site: SOARA maintains a web site with current club information. The URL is: <http://www.soara.org/>

Repeaters: The Laguna Beach, San Clemente, and Trabuco repeaters are open. The Santiago Peak repeaters are closed. For details or questions on the repeaters contact the repeater director, or repeater@soara.org.

2m	— 147.645	— (110.9)	Laguna Beach
2m	— 146.025	+ (110.9)	San Clemente
2m	— 145.240	— (110.9)	Trabuco
D-STAR 2m	— 146.115	+ (K6SOA C)	Laguna Beach
220	— 224.100	— (110.9)	Laguna Beach
220	— 224.640	— (pvt)	Santiago Peak. (C)
440	— 445.660	— (110.9)	Laguna Beach
D-STAR 440	— 445.705	— (K6SOA B)	Laguna Beach
440	— 447.180	— (pvt)	Santiago Peak. (C)
D-STAR 1.2G	1282.600	— (K6SOA A)	Laguna Beach

Nets:

- ☐ 40 meter HF (7.200 MHz +/- , Sundays @ 8 AM
- ☐ 10 meter HF (Technicians Welcome) (28.415 +/-) Sundays @ 9 AM
- ☐ General Membership Net - UHF/VHF (447.180, 147.645 & 224.640): Tuesdays @ 8 PM
- ☐ D-STAR (146.115 C module): Wednesdays @ 8 PM
- ☐ Tech Net - 147.645, 224.640, 447.180: Saturdays @ 9 AM
- ☐ California Rescue Communications (Gordo Net) HF (7.250 MHz +/- for QRM): Weekdays @ 8:30AM
- ☐ MVRACES - 447.180: Tuesdays @ 7PM
- ☐ Tri-Cities RACES - 146.025: Wednesdays @ 8 PM
- ☐ LNACS - 147.645: Thursdays @ 7 PM
- ☐ OC Parks Fire Watch - 447.180: Thursdays @ 8 PM

SOARA OFFICERS

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SOARA APPOINTMENTS

Past President: Ray Hutchinson, , AE6H
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